Contact

www.linkedin.com/in/robthompsonpilot (LinkedIn)
defenseforum.substack.com/ (Blog)

Top Skills

Counter-Terrorist Financing
Foreign Policy
Transportation

Certifications

Private Pilot License (PPL)
Instrument Rating (IFR Rating)
Part 107 Remote Pilot Certificate (sUAS Operator)
Commerical Pilot Certificate | Multi-Engine w/Instrument Privileges

Honors-Awards

Moderator - Self Regulation
Speaker - Pilot Attributes
Moderator - Practicalities of Mapping
Participant - Department of Homeland Security - Unmanned Aircraft Systems (UAS) - Critical Infrastructure
Speaker - British Embassy Washington DC

R Dana Thompson

Policy Writer, Futurist & Historian
Washington, District of Columbia, United States

Summary

R Dana top 1% of LinkedIn influencers has pioneered many technologies, his passions are for all things that fly with innovations in transportation, the future of sustainability, space, diplomacy, security and education. Born into a family of pilots and longtime US leadership who have maintained aircraft for many years, he was afforded the opportunity to have many different types of tools and mentors to shape his life. His innovative use of small unmanned aerial systems for the future of sustainability and wildlife conservation were prevalent in many wildlife conservation initiatives using science, aerospace and policy to protect animals.

R Dana is one of the world's foremost authorities on the subjects of aviation and unmanned aircraft systems for aircraft design, certification, regulation, policy and innovative flight training. Rob's grandfather Donald M Thompson was a pioneering member of the US Air Force by federal appointment granted by Truman in 1947. Don coordinated the command change of NASA in 1958 on behalf of the US Military during its transition from NACA a civil aviation administration to NASA a space administration at the time under the Office of Chief of Transportation, Dept of the Army TCACR.

Virginia who was R Dana's grandmother was an accomplished fixed and rotor wing pilot soloing in 1937 and becoming one of the first female licensed helicopter pilots and later test pilot and consultant on behalf of Bell. Virginia was also the first historian for the famed 99's women pilots group and 1st mid Atlantic chapter president.

R Dana inspired to find and implement solutions around the globe to protect people, create positive solutions, implementing award winning technologies and game changing strategies for animals, the US warfighter, citizens of the US homeland and for those who are in need that supports the US broader strategic mission.

PROJECTS:

Diplomacy, policy, federal regulations, aircraft design, electric motors, propulsion, flight instrument haptic sensing, infrared runway traffic signals, human factors, pilot selection process, attributes of pilots, eye tracking pilots, pilot communication procedures, crew resource management, flight procedures, aerodynamics, aircraft design, UAV development, C-sUAS, waste to energy, lasers, electromagnetic spectrum, STEM education, wildlife conservation, environmental protection, agriculture innovation, application development, advanced display systems, robotics, wearables, 3D printing, data collection, and sensors.

Experience

CUAS Coalition
Founder
July 2017 - Present (8 years 6 months)
Washington, District of Columbia, United States

We secure critical infrastructure—physical and digital—in the age of AI and autonomy. From drafting 23 federal C-UAS regulations to building AI copilots for infrastructure operations, we empower defenders to stay ahead of evolving threats. Our vision: every critical infrastructure team equipped with AI intelligence that predicts problems, reduces complexity, and operates at machine speed.

Helped to draft 23 federal regulatory changes specific to counter drones. These regulations were for several groups, including:
* The Senate Committee on Homeland Security
* The House Armed Services Committee
* The Aviation Sub-Committee
* The House Science Committee
* NDAA2018

Irregular Warfare Center (IWC)
IWGN FAN
July 2025 - Present (6 months)
Crystal City, Virginia, United States

NON-PAID Department of War & Department of Justice Facilitator In Foreign & Domestic Investigations

- Counter Terrorism

- Foreign Assessment
- Aerial Defense Systems
- Counter Narcotics
- AML Financial Systems
- Crypto Fraud
- Homeland Defense Systems
- Naval Systems
- Logistical & Transport Systems

The IW Global Network (IWGN) is a groundbreaking initiative that serves as a force multiplier and coordinator for the Department of War (DoW) and its partners, ultimately aiming to double the warfighter's lethality in the face of modern warfare's complexities. This departure from conventional networks strategically addresses global irregular challenges through a system of Functional Area Networks (FANs), established in collaboration with the Assistant Secretary of Defense for Special Operations/Low Intensity Conflict (ASD SO/LIC) and global partners. These FANs focus on specific areas of concern, fostering cohesive efforts across the DoD, Interagency, private sector, and international partners to maximize Irregular Warfare (IW) capabilities.

Thompson Defense Journal
Writer
June 2025 - Present (7 months)
Washington, District of Columbia, United States

R Dana Thompson is a defense reporter, a third-generation commercial pilot, 2nd youngest graduate of US Army Infantry school, founder of GoldenDome.Vip, and CUAS Coalition LLC. His current interests are in naval warfare and aerial defense.

Golden Dome VIP
Founder
May 2025 - Present (8 months)
Washington, District of Columbia, United States

https://goldendome.vip

sUAS News USA
Reporter
December 2016 - Present (9 years 1 month)
Washington DC-Baltimore Area

Washington DC area reporter

Thompson Aeronautics LLC
Historian
August 2022 - Present (3 years 5 months)

Curator of historically significant aircraft, and historical artifacts related to aeronautics and aerospace. Guardian of the family library which includes +6,000 books on manufacturing, repair, academics, theory, industry, and build publications.

The library is organized in sections:
- pre-WW2
- WW2 to 1975
- 1975 to present

U.S. Department of Homeland Security
Member CIPAC
March 2017 - March 2019 (2 years 1 month)

1st Designated Civilian Member of the Committee as Directed by US Congress for the Protection of the American Public under National Preparedness of Critical Infrastructure.

The U.S. Department of Homeland Security established the Critical Infrastructure Partnership Advisory Council (CIPAC) to facilitate interaction between governmental entities and representatives from the community of critical infrastructure owners and operators.

CIPAC is aligned with and supports the implementation of the National Infrastructure Protection Plan 2013: Partnering for Critical Infrastructure Security and Resilience and Presidential Policy Directive 21, Critical Infrastructure Security and Resilience to provide a forum in which the government and private sector entities, organized as coordinating councils, can jointly engage in a broad spectrum of activities to support and collaborate critical infrastructure security and resilience efforts.

Falcon Foundation UAS
Founder - sUAS Government Affairs
March 2015 - August 2018 (3 years 6 months)
Washington, District of Columbia, United States

Provides leading advocacy efforts in the unmanned aircraft systems industry, managing government relations, committees of association, executing legislative and regulatory strategies. Works independently on advocacy issues, educating the clients on public policy issues quickly by engaging team members to facilitate successful results. Client policy issues will include aviation regulation, unmanned aircraft systems safety, the regulatory process, and industry safety concerns. Client groups include aviation professionals, unmanned aircraft systems, and operators, both commercial and hobbyists, and non-aviation business sectors, including small business service and manufacturing sectors.

Lord Fairfax Community College

sUAS Adjunct Instructor

August 2015 - December 2015 (5 months)

Vint Hill Campus, Virginia

Adjunct professor instructing on the safe use of unmanned aircraft systems for the Virginia Community College System (VCCS) located at Vint Hill.

Zodiac Aerospace

Senior Technical Writer

August 2014 - February 2015 (7 months)

Sterling, VA

Formerly Zodiac Aerospace now Safran Aerosystems

• Translate complex, technical information into clear and simple language.

• Compose a variety of aerospace specific documents, written in Simplified Technical English (STE) using written specifications of iSpec 2200, ASD-STE100, and S1000D for the purpose of authoring training manuals, assembly instructions, user manuals (UM's), component maintenance manuals (CMM's), service bulletins (SB's), and technical reports.

• Prepares and improves templates to ensure consistent high quality written work.

• Oversees, edits, and approves the work of on-site and off-site employees in the Technical Writing and Illustration function.

• Experience with screen capturing, creating illustrations diagrams, and graphical manipulation.

• Researches available product information; interviews remote and local technical experts, subject matter experts SME's; conducts independent tests of technical features as necessary.

• Develops working knowledge of product functional areas as assigned.

• Complete special projects as needed and perform other duties assigned.

ADVANCED AERIALS INC

sUAS Technical Writer

July 2013 - July 2014 (1 year 1 month)

Orange, Virginia

Technical writer for Advanced Aerials (1994) also know as A2USA, one of the first UAV/UAS companies in the industry. Advanced Aerials maintains current contracts with US Army and US Navy in the location and detection of IEDs and mines.

• Provides written communication and gathers technical requirements for content construction in the defense industry.
• Writes and composes educational documents pertaining to automation and Unmanned Aerial Vehicles (UAV) for technical staff, partners, educational institutions and in the federal government.
• Composes government and military documentation and scientific formats that aid in the creation of quad sheets, white papers, business materials, marketing materials, and online communication.
• Fuses civilian and military technical modes of communication.
• Demonstrates knowledge of financial management, government supply chain and professional editing.
• Facilitates communication and technical guidance between contractors' and clients' regarding various statements of work accessing Solidworks drawings and technical document illustrations.

Freelance

Web Developer

November 2009 - June 2013 (3 years 8 months)

Virginia

Freelance IT & Web Developer with experience in the following areas:
• Analyzed and calculated cost estimations for customer accounts.
• Provided technical support, for Windows Environment, MS Office Suite, IT project management, customer end user support, website, SEO and written advertising services.
• Managed, hired, trained, employees and interns for recruiting and local placement and supported daily operations within sales, advertising and technical personnel.
• Created and managed online marketing and advertising campaigns by using Google Analytics, Adwords, blogging, link-wheels, and 3rd party software.

• Assessed and managed organic search engine results, insured that results were meeting clients' goals and adjusted keywords to provide for better search results.
• Installed, maintained and drafted web content for the Content Management Services (CMS) platforms on Drupal 6 & 7, Wordpress 3.0 and Joomla 1.6 for customers.
• Updated client web accounts and orders through Customer Relationship Management (CRM) tools.
• Created illustrations using Adobe CS6, Adobe Illustrator, Photoshop, and Acrobat Reader.

Aviation Service Company (ASCO)
AMT (A&P) Mechanic Assistant
May 1992 - March 2007 (14 years 11 months)

Maintained inventory of tools, equipment and aircraft for family business started in 1948. Helped clients repair aircraft, while instructing proper maintenance procedures for the safe handling and ownership of aircraft. Assisted in over 300 annual inspections, 20 engine overhauls, 5 engine replacements and numerous repairs in sheet metal and engine components. Assisted in accident recovery and location of aircraft in the Shenandoah Valley. Placed orders, organized paper work, log books, filed airworthiness directives (AD's) and maintained Jeppesen instrument plates for pilots use. Attended conferences and safety seminars held by the FAA for flight safety and maintenance.

Virginia Army National Guard
Infantry Soldier
June 1994 - June 2002 (8 years 1 month)
Woodstock, VA

Member of the 29th Infantry Division 3/116th
Military Occupation Specialties -11B1
Machine Gunner, Small Arms Trainer & Foreign Weapons Specialist

Extensive knowledge of the various types of U.S. and foreign small arms, sub-machine guns, machine guns, grenade launchers, forward-observer procedures, directing fire and indirect-fire weapons (mortars) and anti-tank missiles.
Learned the capabilities and characteristics of U.S. and foreign air defense and anti-tank weapons systems, tactical training and range fire as well as how to teach marksmanship and the employment of weapons to others. Employed

conventional and unconventional tactics and techniques as tactical weapon specialist.

• Expert Marksman -Grenades, Machine-gun
• Sharpshooter -Rifle
• Air Assault –Fast rappelled from helicopters Huey and Blackhawks
• Foreign Weapons Training

Education

James Madison University

Master of Science Degree, Technical & Scientific Communication · (2012 - 2013)

James Madison University

Bachelor of Science Degree, Aeronautical Science & Technical Communication · (2005 - 2010)

Computer Learning Center of Manassas

Associate of Science (A.S.), Network Engineering and Management · (1999 - 2000)

Aviation Service Company (ASCO)

FAA Certified Commercial Pilot, Aviation/Airway Management and Operations · (1993 - 2001)